

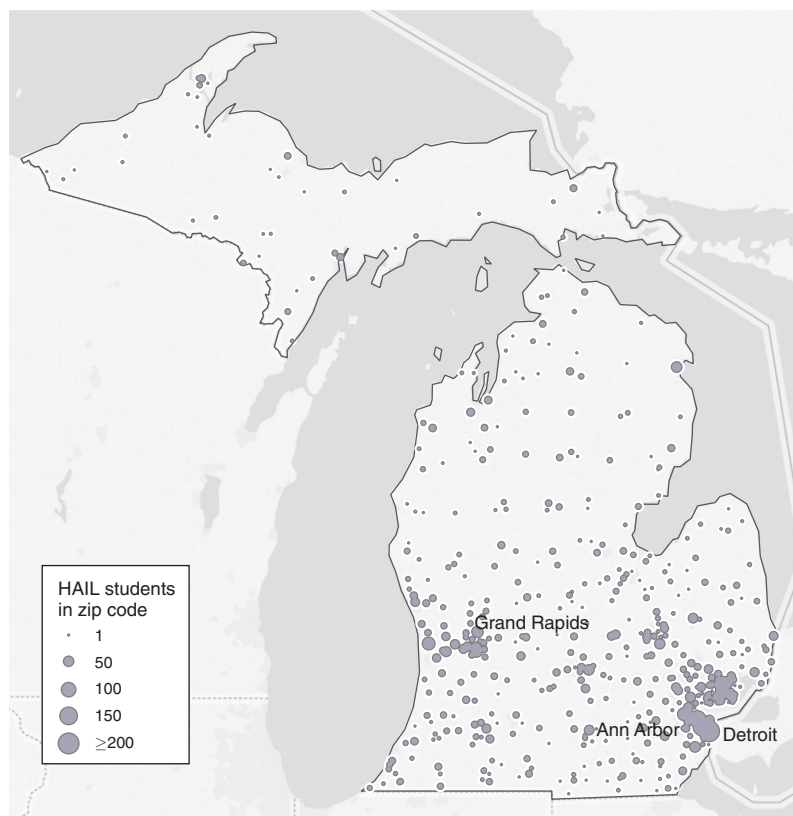


FIGURE 2. HAIL STUDENTS ARE WIDELY DISPERSED ACROSS MICHIGAN, FIRST AND SECOND HAIL COHORTS

cohort, 875 students in 238 high schools were in the treatment group, while 927 students in 259 high schools were in the control group.

Sample characteristics are shown in Table 2. The table shows tests for balance (within each stratum) between treatment and control groups. Forty percent of the schools in the treatment and control groups are in the southeast region of the state, near Ann Arbor, Lansing, and Detroit. Another 14 percent of schools are in the largely rural Upper Peninsula. The remaining schools are scattered across the Lower Peninsula, with many concentrated in the Grand Rapids area. Over half of the schools are rural, one-third are suburban, and the remainder urban.

The overwhelming majority (78 percent) of sample students are White (non-Hispanic), reflecting the strong correlation (in Michigan and the United States) between academic achievement and race. Nine percent are Black (non-Hispanic) and 6 percent are Hispanic.¹⁸ A majority are female (59 percent). All of these statistics track patterns of academic achievement in the state and nationwide.

A glance through the table shows balance on all characteristics. This is substantiated by a joint F -test, which reveals that, together, these characteristics do not predict

¹⁸Students are coded as Hispanic if they identify as Hispanic, regardless of race. For students of multiple races, a single race category is assigned according to the following hierarchy: Black, Native American, Asian, Hawaiian/Pacific Islander, White.